STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-6300

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **11/22/24**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES
SUBJECT AUTHORIZED RESTRAINTS	CROSS REFERENCE G-6310 ELECTRONIC RESTRAINTS G-6400 CUSTODIAL DEATH PREVENTION J-3500 SECURITY AND CONTROL

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for the use of authorized restraints including handcuffs.

II. Policy:

Employees of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall only use those restraints authorized in this policy. Authorized employees, including all sworn personnel, shall receive training in the use of handcuffs and other authorized restraints and shall exercise reasonable care in the use of these devices. Restraints shall not be used for punishment.

III. Procedures:

A. Authorized Restraints: Only the following authorized restraints shall be used by employees of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office:

1. Handcuffs (chained or hinged), black or silver in color only.
2. Leg Shackles.
3. Transport Belt.
4. Restraint Chair w/ optional protective helmet (see J-3500 Security and Control).
5. Electronic Restraints (see G-6310 Electronic Restraints).
6. Flex-cuffs.
7. Hobble.
8. Spit net.
9. The WRAP.

B. **Handcuffs:** The purpose of handcuffs is to temporarily restrain the movements of a subject and hamper physical resistance. Handcuffs shall be used as follows:

1. Subjects arrested and taken into custody (including emergency protective committals) shall be handcuffed behind their back and the handcuffs shall be double locked.

a) An exception may be made for a subject that has an injury that does not permit his or her arms to move behind his or her back. Other factors such as the subject's age, physical condition, or other physical limitations may also dictate the use of alternative techniques or restraints.

b) Employees shall seek approval from a supervisor prior to deviating from this policy.

2. Employees shall ensure handcuffs are not unnecessarily tight. If a subject complains regarding the tightness of the handcuffs, the employee shall check and, if necessary, adjust the handcuffs, if it is safe to do so.

3. Subjects shall be handcuffed prior to pat searching.

4. Except under emergency circumstances, subjects shall not be handcuffed or attached to fixed objects, nor left unattended while restrained.

C. **Flex-cuffs:** Flex-cuffs may be used when conventional handcuffs are unavailable or impractical.

1. Flex-cuffs shall be used following standard handcuffing guidelines in section B above.

2. Flex-cuffs may be used to secure a violent subject's ankles.

3. Flex-cuffs should be removed as soon as possible.

D. **Hobbles:** A hobble is a soft restraint generally used to immobilize the legs of a combative subject. Only deputies authorized and trained to utilize a hobble may do so. Hobbles shall be used adhering to the following guidelines:

1. Hobbles may be used as a waist belt to secure handcuffs.

2. Hobbles may be used to secure a subject's arms.

3. Hobbles may be used to secure the legs of a subject that is combative or an escape risk. A hobble may also be used to secure a subject's legs during transport.

a) Hobbles may be applied to the ankles or knees and shall not be attached to handcuffs.

b) Subjects shall never be “hog tied” (i.e. restrained face down with hands behind the back and legs tied to the handcuffs).

c) When transporting a hobbled subject, the trailing end of the hobble must be anchored inside the passenger door of the patrol unit. The trailing end shall never be left outside of the vehicle while transporting.

E. **Spit Net:** A spit net is a temporary protective head covering that prevents the wearer from transmitting fluids (saliva and mucous) to others.

1. A spit net shall only be used on a subject that is actively attempting to spit on or bite employees.

2. The spit net may be secured under the subject’s arms, but shall not be secured around the subject’s neck.

3. The spit net shall be removed as soon as the subject’s behavior ceases.

4. Spit nets shall not be reused.

5. Any subject placed in a spit net shall have constant and direct supervision.

F. **The Wrap:** The WRAP is a full body restraint system generally used for parties who continue to resist arrest after being handcuffed. Once applied, the WRAP helps reduce force necessary to restrain an individual and injuries that may be incurred in the process. The WRAP should be applied in its entirety to a subject per the manufacturer’s design. The WRAP should be made available by the shift supervisor or assigned deputy.

1. The padded head piece and spit masks can be used as needed.

2. If the WRAP is applied to a subject, a WRAP trained law enforcement officer shall always stay with that person, until it is removed.

3. Applying the WRAP on a subject for another agency and then letting them take the subject to the hospital or jail without a WRAP trained Law Enforcement Officer present should be avoided.

4. The mere application of the WRAP does not require a Use of Force report, if no injuries are incurred.

5. Transportation of a subject in the WRAP shall be done by rescue squad. A supervisor may authorize transport by cruiser if a rescue squad is unavailable.

6. Only trained deputies shall utilize the WRAP. Untrained deputies may assist a trained deputy in utilizing the WRAP.

7. The WRAP shall be cleaned and maintained by a WRAP Instructor quarterly.

G. Medical Precautions: Whenever a subject is restrained, employees on scene must be alert to medical implications relating to the restraint of the subject (see G-6400 Custodial Death Prevention).